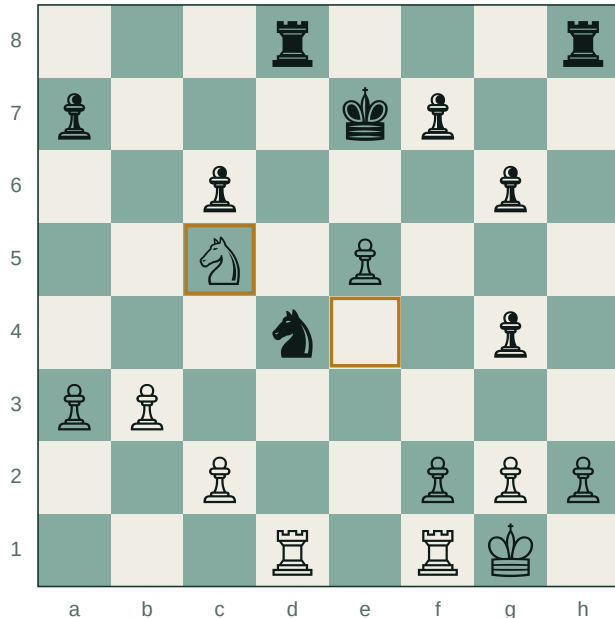


Anastasia mating nets: Black, move 23

Anastasia mating nets

Black to move



Previous move: 23.Nxc5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Ne2+ 24. Kh1 Rxh2+ 25. Kxh2 Rh8#

23...Ne2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the rook on d8 attacks the rook on d1. Recorded reply: **24.Kh1**.

24...Rxh2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h2. Recorded reply: **25.Kxh2**.

25...Rh8# Mate: rook on h8 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An Anastasia-type net uses a knight to restrict king escapes while a rook or queen checks along an edge file. Removing a pawn shield can be the crucial preparation.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: knight on c5. Check for tactical protection.